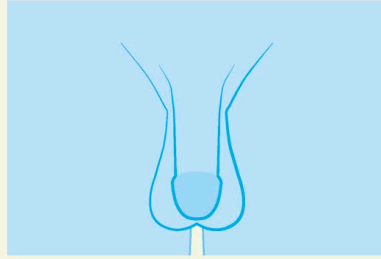
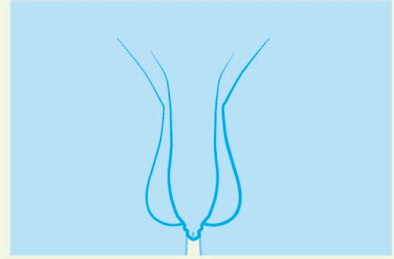


Circumcision

The operation to remove the foreskin is known as circumcision. About one-third of all males are circumcised, and it usually happens for religious or cultural reasons, although it can be recommended on medical grounds if the foreskin is too tight or if it regularly becomes infected. A general or local anesthetic is usually administered before the procedure is carried out. Circumcision does not affect how the penis works or how the penis looks when erect.



△ **Circumcised penis**
The foreskin has been removed and the glans of the penis is exposed.

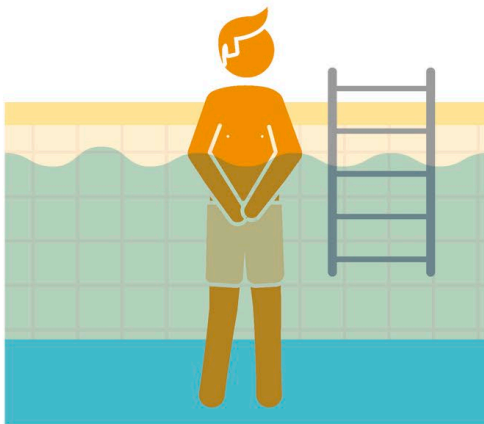


△ **Uncircumcised penis**
The foreskin forms a retractable hood over the glans of the penis.

Erections

An erection happens when the penis fills with blood and becomes stiff. About 0.2 pt. (100 ml) of blood floods into the corpora cavernosa on the top side of the penis, and the corpus spongiosum on the under side. Most penises point upward when erect, but they can also point to the side, straight, or downward.

Though erections usually happen when a male is sexually aroused, they can also happen spontaneously, or during sleep.



△ **Spontaneous erections**
During the teen years, spontaneous erections are likely to occur more frequently—this can be embarrassing, but it's best to laugh it off.

Ejaculation

An ejaculation occurs when semen, a milky fluid containing sperm, is expelled from the penis. The process begins in the testicles, where sperm is produced, before being stored for a short time in the epididymis. From there, sperm travels via the vas deferens, combining with seminal fluid from the seminal vesicle and prostate gland to create semen. During an ejaculation, signals are sent to the muscles at the base of the penis, which contract to push the semen out of the erect penis.

The ejection of semen usually happens during masturbation or sexual intercourse and is a pleasurable experience, but it can also happen involuntarily during sleep – this is known as a “wet dream”.

GOOD TO KNOW

Wet dreams

An ejaculation that happens during sleep is commonly known as a “wet dream.” Wet dreams tend to be a regular occurrence during the teen years, although they happen to some people more frequently than others.

Teens are likely to feel embarrassed, but it's a natural part of growing up. Cleaning the penis and testicles thoroughly and changing the bedsheets first thing in the morning is a good idea.

